

Interview 1 - I interviewed my friend Devesh from discrete math

Opening:

“Hi! I’m taking this really cool class called Start Up Studio, and we’re working on a navigation app. Would you mind chatting with me about the idea and giving me some feedback?”

Problem Exploration:

“So I’m sure you use Google Maps, but do you find that it is basically useless when you’re inside a building?”

“Like, have you ever been in a huge building and had no idea where your classroom or meeting room was?”

He said, “Yeah, definitely. Especially in buildings I’ve never been in before. I usually end up walking around until I find the room.”

Current Solutions:

“When you’re lost in a building, what do you normally do?”

He said, “Usually I just look for signs. If there aren’t any good signs, then I’ll ask someone. I don’t really love asking people because I feel stupid when I’m clearly just lost.”

Solution Signal:

“What concerns would you have with an app like this?”

He said, “My first thought is accuracy. If it tells me to turn left and there’s actually no hallway there, I’m going to stop trusting it.”

“Have you tried anything similar before?”

He said, “Not really. Google Maps sometimes tells you what floor something is on, but it doesn’t actually guide you through the building.”

Wrap Up:

“If we released a beta version, would you download it if it cost \$10?”

He said, “Probably not for \$10. I’d try it for free though. If it was really useful, maybe I’d pay later.”

Interview 2: I interviewed my roommate's friend

Opening:

"Hi! My name is Ishani Mitra, and I'm a student at Columbia. I'm taking Start Up Studio, and we're working on a navigation app that helps people navigate inside buildings. Would you mind talking to me about it and giving me some feedback?"

Problem Exploration:

"Do you ever find Google Maps useless when you're inside a building?"

He said, "Oh my god, yes."

"Like, imagine it's your first day of class and you're trying to find a classroom. Would you ever get stressed about being late because you can't find the room?"

He said, "Absolutely. I've definitely shown up late because I couldn't figure out where I was supposed to go."

Current Solutions:

"When you're lost inside a building, what do you normally do?"

He said, "I'll look at the signs first, and then I'll probably ask someone. Sometimes I'll just walk around and hope I find it."

"Do you like that solution?"

He said, "No. Especially if I'm in a rush. I just want someone to tell me exactly where to go."

Solution Signal:

"What concerns would you have about an app like this?"

He said, "Honestly, I think the biggest thing would be whether the directions are actually accurate."

"Would you be comfortable with it collecting your location?"

He said, "Yeah, I don't really care. Google already knows where I am anyway."

"Have you tried anything like this before?"

He said, "No, but I've always thought it would be useful."

Wrap Up:

“If we released a beta version, would you download it if it cost \$10?”

He said, “Yeah, probably. If it actually worked. I’d rather pay \$10 than spend 20 minutes wandering around a building.”

Interview 3 - I interviewed my friend Jude from a club I am in

Opening:

“Hi! I’m taking Start Up Studio, and we’re working on an indoor navigation app. Would you mind chatting with me about the idea?”

Problem Exploration:

“Do you find Google Maps pretty useless when you’re inside buildings?”

He said, “Sometimes, but honestly not really.”

“Have you ever had trouble finding a classroom or room in a new building?”

He said, “Yeah, but usually I just follow the signs or ask someone.”

Current Solutions:

“When you’re lost in a building, what do you normally do?”

He said, “I just ask someone.”

“Do you find that annoying?”

He said, “Not really. Usually someone knows where it is.”

Solution Signal:

“What concerns would you have about an app like this?”

He said, “I guess I’d wonder how accurate it is. If I have to use the app and then double-check the signs anyway, there’s not much point.”

“Would you use something like this?”

He said, “Maybe. It would depend on how much easier it actually makes things.”

Wrap Up:

“If we released a beta version, would you download it if it cost \$10?”

He said, "Probably not. I don't really have enough of a problem with this to pay for it. I'd download it for free though."